Employee Leave and Attendance Policy

Document ID: EN-POL-02 **Department:** Human Resources **Version:** 5.0 **Effective Date:** 1 January 2026 **Review Cycle:** Annual

1. Purpose

This policy sets out the entitlements, procedures, and responsibilities relating to employee leave and attendance at Meridian Holdings Group, ensuring consistent and fair treatment across all departments.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all permanent, full-time, and part-time employees. Entitlements for contractors and temporary staff are governed separately by the terms of their individual engagement contracts.

3. Annual Leave

3.1 Full-time employees accrue twenty-five working days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays observed in the employee's country of employment.

3.2 Annual leave accrues on a pro-rata basis for employees who join or leave the Company partway through the calendar year.

3.3 A maximum of five unused annual leave days may be carried over into the following calendar year, subject to line manager approval. Any leave in excess of this limit will be forfeited unless otherwise agreed in writing.

3.4 Leave requests must be submitted through the HR Self-Service Portal at least two weeks in advance for periods of five or more consecutive working days, and at least three working days in advance for shorter periods.

4. Sick Leave

4.1 Employees are entitled to fourteen days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Absences of more than three consecutive working days require a medical certificate submitted to the HR Department within five working days of the employee's return to work.

4.2 Employees must notify their line manager of sickness absence before their normal start time on the first day of absence, either by telephone or through the HR Self-Service Portal.

5. Parental Leave

5.1 Employees who have completed at least twelve months of continuous service are entitled to sixteen weeks of paid maternity leave and four weeks of paid paternity leave, in accordance with applicable local labour law, whichever provides the greater entitlement.

5.2 Requests for parental leave must be submitted to HR at least eight weeks before the expected start date, accompanied by appropriate medical documentation.

6. Unpaid Leave

6.1 Employees may request unpaid leave of absence for personal reasons. Such requests require approval from the employee's line manager and the relevant Head of Department, and must not exceed three months in duration without separate approval from the Chief Human Resources Officer.

7. Attendance and Punctuality

7.1 Employees are expected to arrive at their designated workplace, or log in for remote work, at their scheduled start time. Persistent lateness will be addressed through the Company's Performance Management Procedure.

7.2 Unauthorised absence, defined as absence without prior approval or notification in accordance with Section 4.2, may be treated as a disciplinary matter.

8. Record Keeping

8.1 All leave and attendance records are maintained in the HR Information System and retained for a minimum of six years in accordance with the Company's Data Retention Schedule.

9. Related Documents

- Performance Management Procedure (HR-PROC-11)
- Data Retention Schedule (LEGAL-POL-05)

10. Approval

Approved by the Chief Human Resources Officer on 5 December 2025, superseding version 4.3 dated 3 January 2025.